unfounded concerns perpetuated by those who fear losing power, and certain sections of the media.

Rahul ji was yet to come out of the temporary camp set up at the Meena High Court. I met the state Congress General Secretary Jaswant Gurjar in the camp. He was active in the Rajasthan leg of the Yatra as a contact person between the party and civil society. We continued our conversation and Jaswant ji guided us to a nearby tea and breakfast stall. He insisted that having something to eat would make the walk more comfortable, and we agreed.

Around 5.30 a.m. the camp came to life in a flurry of activity. People lined up, carrying their belongings, flags and other materials for the day's walk. Rahul Gandhi and the chief minister raised the flag, and the crowd echoed with chants of '*Jodo Jodo Bharat Jodo*', '*Chhodo Chhodo Nafrat Chhodo*' and '*Nafrat Chhodo Bharat Jodo*'. Seeing such a huge crowd, I felt that it would hardly be possible to meet Rahul Gandhi—I might not even be able to get a glimpse of him. But by 6 a.m., I got to know that I would have to stand at a point about 8 kilometres before Dausa city, so that from there I could be taken to Rahul ji. I reached the said place by car as per the schedule. After dropping me, Ganesh took Om Thanvi ji in the car to the point fixed for him. I stood on the side of the road and watched. There was so much enthusiasm among the people coming and going on the road. The roads were full of people carrying the Tricolour. It was December, a very chilly morning, but the enthusiasm among the people made it warm. Around 8 o'clock, the first civil society group passed in front of me, in which Jairam Ramesh ji, Shankar Singh ji and Yogendra Yadav ji were seen. I immediately greeted them by shaking their hands, but did not move from my place since I had strict instructions to wait there. Within a few minutes, Varun ji, who was my contact person for this meeting, reached me.

It took us some time to reach Rahul ji in the D circle of security. Varun ji took me far back and held my hand, saying that we would slowly keep moving forward. And in about ten minutes we reached Rahul ji. I saw that Nikhil Dey, a social activist associated with the Information and Employment Rights Campaign, and Dharamchand Khair, of the Adivasi